



BIKES



Bicycles were invented in the late 1700s. But they have changed their shape so much over the years that some early bikes such as the “ordinary” bicycle, also called the penny-farthing, look very strange to us today. Power for a bicycle comes from the rider, but sometimes the rider simply runs out of energy! In 1885 a German, Gottlieb Daimler, added an engine to the bicycle, and the motorcycle was invented. The very first motorcycles had tiny steam engines, but today they have gasoline engines, and can move more than match cars for speed.



Pollution-free traffic

In the Netherlands, there are more bicycles than people. Nearly 40 percent of all trips taken in the capital, Amsterdam, are on bikes. Imagine the terrible fumes, and the effect on the environment if all these riders drove cars instead of pollution-free bicycles.



Fix it yourself

Bicycles are simple machines and one of the cheapest forms of transportation. Most repairs on bicycles are quite simple, too, and can be done cheaply and easily by their owners.

Protective helmet

Reflective strips help motorists to see cyclists at night.

The pedals are linked to the back wheel by a chain.

The brakes are operated by levers on the handlebars.

